HAVING AGREED, at its sixty-eighth session, that the criteria for the identification and designation of a PSSA provided in resolution A.982(24) are fulfilled for the extension of the GBR and TS PSSA to include the south-west part of the Coral Sea,

HAVING NOTED that the Sub-Committee on Navigation, Communications and Search and Rescue (NCSR), at its second session, approved the establishment of two 5 nautical mile wide two-way routes and a new area to be avoided in the south-west Coral Sea as associated protective measures for the application to extend the GBR and TS PSSA to include the south-west part of the Coral Sea to improve the safety of navigation and the protection of the marine environment,

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SOURCE: MEPC.268(68).pdf
associated protective measures for the application to extend the GBR and TS PSSA to include the south-west part of the Coral Sea to improve the safety of navigation and the protection of the marine environment,

1 DESIGNATES the south-west part of the Coral Sea, as defined in annex 1 to the present resolution, as an extension of the Great Barrier Reef and Torres Strait PSSA pending the final adoption of the associated protective measures for the PSSA, as set out in annex 1 of document NCSR 2/23;

2 INVITES Member Governments to recognize the ecological, social, cultural , economic and scientific attributes of the Coral Sea area, set forth in annex 2 to the present resolution, as well as its vulnerability to damage by international shipping activities, as described in annex 3 to the present resolution;

3 FURTHER INVITES Member Governments to note the associated protective measures established to address the area's vulnerability, the details of which are contained in annex 4 to the present resolution, which are expected to enter into force following final adoption by the ninety-fifth session of the Maritime Safety Committee, on a date to be

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SOURCE: MEPC.268(68).pdf
in annex 4 to the present resolution, which are expected to enter into force following final adoption by the ninety-fifth session of the Maritime Safety Committee, on a date to be circulated by the Organization to all Member Governments, and request ships flying their flag to act in accordance with such measures.
RESOLUTION MEPC.268(68)
(adopted on 15 May 2015)
DESIGNATION OF THE SOUTH-WEST CORAL SEA AS AN EXTENSION OF THE GREAT BARRIER REEF AND TORRES STRAIT PARTICULARLY SENSITIVE SEA AREAMEPC 68/21/Add.1
Annex 14, page 2

https://edocs.imo.org/Final Documents/English/MEPC 68-21-ADD.1 (E).doc
ANNEX 1

DESCRIPTION OF THE GREAT BARRIER REEF, TORRES STRAIT AND CORAL SEA PARTICULARLY SENSITIVE SEA AREA1

Description of the Particularly Sensitive Sea Area

To minimize the risk of damage from ship groundings and pollution damage by international shipping activities and the destruction and degradation of this unique, diverse, and significant habitats and ecosystem, mariners should exercise extreme care when navigating in the area bounded by a line connecting the following geographical positions which is designated as a Particularly Sensitive Sea Area:

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SOURCE: MEPC.268(68).pdf
habitats and ecosystem, mariners should exercise extreme care when navigating in the area bounded by a line connecting the following geographical positions which is designated as a Particularly Sensitive Sea Area:

(a) commencing at a point on the coast of Australia in latitude 11°00' South, longitude 142°08' East;
(b) running thence north-westerly along the geodesic to the point of latitude 10°28' South, longitude 141°20' East;
(c) thence north along the meridian of longitude 141°20' East to its intersection by the parallel point of latitude 9°33' South;
(d) thence north-easterly along the geodesic to the point of latitude 9°13' South, longitude 141°57' East;
(e) thence north along the meridian of longitude 141°57' East to its intersection by the southern coastline of the island of Papua New Guinea at low water;
(f) thence generally easterly along the southern coastline of the island of New Guinea, that is along the low water line on that coast and across any river mouth and in the case of the mouth of the Mai Kussa River along the parallel of latitude 9°09' South, thence along the southern coastline of the island of

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SOURCE: MEPC.268(68).pdf
New Guinea, that is along the low water line on that coast and across any river mouth and in the case of the mouth of the Mai Kussa River along the parallel of latitude 9°09' South, thence along the southern coastline of the island of New Guinea, that is along the low water line on that coast and across any river mouth to its intersection by the meridian of longitude 142°36' East;
(g) thence south along that meridian to its intersection by the parallel of latitude 9°21' South;
(h) thence north-easterly along the geodesic between that point of intersection and the point of latitude 9°09' South, longitude 143°47'20" East;
(i) thence along the outer limit of the three-mile territorial sea of Black Rocks, so as to pass to the north-west of Black Rocks, to the point of intersection of that limit by the outer limit of the three-mile territorial sea of Bramble Cay;
(j) thence along that outer limit, so as to pass successively to the north and east of Bramble Cay, to the point of latitude 9°08'30" South, longitude 143°55'57" East;
(k) thence north-easterly to the point of latitude 9°00' South, longitude 144°30' East;

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SOURCE: MEPC.268(68).pdf
Bramble Cay, to the point of latitude 9°08'30" South, longitude 143°55'57" East;
(k) thence north-easterly to the point of latitude 9°00' South, longitude 144°30'

East;
(l) thence generally southerly along a line joining the following geographic positions:
a. 10°41' S 145°00' E
b. 13°00' S 145°00' E
(m) thence easterly to a point of latitude 13°00' South, longitude 147°00' East;
(n) thence generally south-easterly to a point of latitude 19°00' South, longitude 156°00' East;
(o) thence south to a point of latitude 24°30' South, longitude 156°00' East;
(p) thence westerly along the parallel of latitude 24°30' South to its intersection by the coastline of Queensland at low water; and
(q) thence generally northerly along that coastline at low water to the point of commencement.

1 The text in this annex is taken from Australias submission contained in document MEPC 68/10/1.

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SOURCE: MEPC.268(68).pdf
RESOLUTION MEPC.268(68)
(adopted on 15 May 2015)
DESIGNATION OF THE SOUTH-WEST CORAL SEA AS AN EXTENSION OF THE GREAT BARRIER REEF AND TORRES STRAIT PARTICULARLY SENSITIVE SEA AREAMEPC 68/21/Add.1
Annex 14, page 3

Note: The geographic positions from sections (a) to (k) inclusive are those in resolution MEPC.133(53), adopted in 2005 to define the Great Barrier Reef and Torres Strait Particularly Sensitive Sea Area.

All coordinates are based on the WGS84 datum and are depicted in the diagram in the chartlet below.

RESOLUTION MEPC.268(68)
(adopted on 15 May 2015)
DESIGNATION OF THE SOUTH-WEST CORAL SEA AS AN EXTENSION OF THE GREAT BARRIER REEF AND TORRES STRAIT PARTICULARLY SENSITIVE SEA AREAMEPC 68/21/Add.1

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ANNEX 2

ECOLOGICAL, SOCIO-ECONOMIC, AND SCIENTIFIC ATTRIBUTES OF THE PSSA EXTENSION AREA: SOUTH-WEST CORAL SEA

(Note: More detailed descriptions of the ecological, socio-economic and cultural, scientific

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SOURCE: MEPC.268(68).pdf
ANNEX 2

ECOLOGICAL, SOCIO-ECONOMIC, AND SCIENTIFIC ATTRIBUTES OF THE PSSA EXTENSION AREA: SOUTH-WEST CORAL SEA

(Note: More detailed descriptions of the ecological, socio-economic and cultural, scientific and educational criteria are contained in paragraphs 17 to 80 of document MEPC 68/10/1.)

1 Ecological criteria

Uniqueness or rarity

1.1 The Coral Sea is considered one of the most distinctive and undisturbed natural systems in the world and is internationally recognized for its rich biodiversity, unique species and important heritage values.

1.2 In the area of the Coral Sea to be covered by the PSSA, three large-scale unique